

M. S. RAMAIAH UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES

Faculty of Engineering and Technology | Bengaluru – 560058, Karnataka



IGNITE

Internships · Growth · Networking · Industry · Technology · Exposure

PROPOSAL FOR ESTABLISHMENT

As a Committee of the University

A Cross-Branch, Student-Led Industry–Academia Bridge Initiative

PROPOSED BY

Sai Gandhi V

Student Initiator, IGNITE
Technical Officer, ASME Student Chapter
4th Year B.Tech, Mechanical Engineering, MSRUAS

FACULTY MENTOR

Dr. MURUGESH M C

Associate Professor, Department of Mechanical
Engineering, MSRUAS
Submitted to: Office of the Dean, MSRUAS
| July 2026

4

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH STUDIES

7

ENGINEERING BRANCHES COVERED

1

LETTER OF APPRECIATION RECEIVED

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

IGNITE is a student-led, cross-branch initiative at MSRUAS working to bridging the gap between what industry expects from fresh engineering graduates and what students are prepared for today — through structured industry engagement, a growing internship pipeline, and a dedicated digital portal now in development to connect students, faculty, and companies directly.

IGNITE is backed by four independent research studies, institutional recognition, an established industry-contact network, and an operating model already under development. The initiative now seeks formal recognition as an official cross-branch university committee.

Pillar	What It Means
Research-backed	Built on four independent research studies — one covering student needs across 7+ departments, and three covering industry expectations across Bengaluru and five other states
Cross-branch by design	Designed for all engineering branches.
Digitally enabled	A dedicated IGNITE web portal — the corridor connecting university and industry — is already under active development
Placement-aligned	Prepares students earlier and better; designed to strengthen, not compete with, the Placement Department
Minimal-budget design	operates with a lean, controlled budget focused only on essential costs such as domain maintenance, logistics, printing, events, and guest lectures.
Proven commitment	Letter of Appreciation signed by the then-Faculty Mentor, the Head of Department, and the Associate Dean — February 2026

1. THE PROBLEM — WHY IGNITE MUST EXIST

Four independent studies conducted within and around MSRUAS — one internal student survey and three separate industry-facing surveys — reveal the same consistent, urgent gap: students want internships and industry exposure but lack the awareness, skills, and structured connections to access them, while industry is genuinely open to engaging but has no repeatable, student-led channel to connect through.



1.1 What Students Are Facing — ASME PULSE Survey 2025–26

An internal survey of 22 students conducted by the ASME Student Chapter across 7-plus departments (Mechanical, Robotics, Automotive, CSE, AIML, ECE, and MME) in April 2026 found:

Student survey — 22 students across 7+ engineering departments:

- 77.3% were actively seeking or planning to seek internships.
- The leading barriers were lack of certifications/hands-on skills (45.5%) and not knowing where to start (31.8%).
- Robotics & Automation was the most preferred domain (50%), while 36.4% specifically requested CAD and technical-tool workshops.

1.2 What Industry Is Telling Us — Three Independent Surveys

Study	Sample	Key finding
Peenya	4 companies	75% rated practical-knowledge gap "Extremely" challenging
Bengaluru	6 companies	Practical-experience gap: 4.5/5; 67% open to collaboration
Pan-India	13 companies / 5 states	Hands-on experience: 4.17/5 importance

Across three independently conducted industry studies, the same practical-experience gap consistently emerged as a major hiring challenge.

The Core Gap

No structured, repeatable, student-led system exists at MSRUAS today to connect students to industry before placement season, across every branch, as a matter of routine rather than individual effort. IGNITE is that system.

2. WHAT IS IGNITE?

Ensure that every student — in every branch — gets access to multiple internship and practical-exposure opportunities, and has the knowledge, skills, and connections to choose confidently among them.

IGNITE — Internships, Growth, Networking, Industry, Technology and Exposure — is a cross-branch, student-led initiative guided by faculty and designed to work alongside the Placement Department.

Research-backed: Built on independent student and industry research.

Cross-branch: Designed for every engineering branch.

Self-sustaining: Processes, contacts and knowledge are documented for continuity.

3. HOW IGNITE WORKS — STRUCTURE & WORKFLOW

IGNITE is not an events club. It is a structured, repeating operating model with a clear escalation path — designed so that no single person, including the Student Initiator, is a bottleneck for any branch.

3.1 The Structure

Layer	Made Up Of	Role
IGNITE Main Committee	President/Student Initiator + core team	Overall direction, escalated company outreach, Placement Dept. liaison, faculty & Dean-office coordination
Faculty Mentor(s)	1 per department, ideally	Guidance, institutional credibility, sign-off on department-level asks
Branch Representatives	2 students per branch	First point of contact for their branch; run the Internal Branch Committee
Internal Branch Committee	Branch Reps + branch faculty	Identify branch-specific challenges; build the branch's target company list
Placement Department	Institutional partner	Steps in when a branch cannot establish contact on its own; carries institutional weight in outreach

3.2 The Workflow — From Branch Challenge to Company Partnership

This is the same loop for every branch, every semester:

- Form **Internal Branch Committee** for CSE, ECE, ME etc., — Branch representatives + faculty identify interested students.
- Diagnose **Needs** — Identify internship, skill, project and placement gaps.
- Build **Company List** — Identify relevant companies and required engagement.
- Direct **Outreach** — Branch committee attempts initial contact.
- Escalate — Unsuccessful leads move to the Main Committee.
- Placement **Support** — Main Committee + Placement Department pursue institutional outreach.
- Onboard — Confirmed companies enter the IGNITE portal.

Branches initiate outreach independently; unresolved leads escalate to the Main Committee and Placement Department, preventing central bottlenecks.

4. THE IGNITE DIGITAL PORTAL

Once a company is onboarded through the workflow in Section 3, the relationship moves onto a dedicated IGNITE website — the digital corridor between university and industry, and a self-serve portal that replaces repeated manual follow-up with a system every stakeholder can log into directly.

Current Status: In Development

The portal is being actively built, not yet publicly launched. The portal is currently in development and will be refined using feedback from students, faculty and participating companies during the approval and pilot stages.

Stakeholder Portal Function

Companies	Post internships/projects/workshops, view verified student profiles, shortlist candidates and manage opportunities
Students	View active opportunities, maintain profiles and receive selection notifications
Faculty	Verify student data, monitor company engagement and provide current industry input for curriculum discussions

Why the Portal Comes After the Relationship: Companies receive portal access only after a genuine university relationship is established through branch-level or Placement Department outreach. The portal therefore manages verified relationships rather than functioning as a cold marketing platform.

5. RESEARCH FOUNDATION — EVIDENCE BASE

IGNITE is not proposing a concept and asking the university to take it on faith. Four independent studies already completed form its evidence base — one covering student demand, and three separately covering industry expectations, conducted months apart with different companies.

5.1 Four Independent Studies at a Glance

Study	Sample	Period	Headline Finding
ASME PULSE (Internal Student Survey)	22 students, 7+ departments	April 2026	77.3% actively seeking internships; skills/certification gap (45.5%) is the top-cited barrier
Peenya Industrial Area Survey	4 verified company respondents	Apr–May 2025	75% rate the practical-knowledge gap in fresh graduates as "Extremely" challenging
ME Industry Landscape Survey — Bengaluru	6 verified responses	Oct–Nov 2025	Practical-experience gap rated 4.5/5; 67% open to academia collaboration — earned the Letter of Appreciation
ME Industry Landscape Survey — Pan-India	13 verified companies, 6 hubs / 5 states	March 2026	Practical-experience gap 3.46/5 severity; hands-on experience 4.17/5 importance — the single most-valued skill overall

5.2 Official Recognition

Institutional Recognition — 25 February 2026

The Department of Mechanical Engineering recognised IGNITE's Bengaluru industry survey as a credible contribution to understanding industry expectations.

5.3 An Actively Growing Industry Network

Industry Network: An independently developed database of verified industry contacts provides IGNITE with an initial outreach pipeline for future company engagement.

6. INDUSTRY ENGAGEMENT FRAMEWORK — THE GIVE & TAKE

Every interaction with industry follows a clear, equal exchange. Companies engage only when they see concrete value in return for their time — IGNITE is built around having that value ready before the first conversation.

6.1 What IGNITE Asks from Industry

IGNITE asks companies for:

- 20–30 minutes for structured industry insight
- Hiring expectations, skill-gap and technology inputs
- Internship/project opportunities where feasible
- A non-binding Letter of Intent where appropriate

6.2 What Industry Gets in Return

Companies receive:

- Access to motivated student talent
- Industry benchmark insights
- Student project support
- Early access to potential interns and future recruits

6.3 Domain-Wise Offering

Industry engagement will be tailored by domain, including manufacturing, robotics/automation, digital industry, design/R&D, recruitment and quality/testing.

6.4 The Letter of Intent Process

Letter of Intent: A one-page, non-binding document recording the company's willingness to engage with IGNITE and, where applicable, the nature of internships, projects, duration and benefits.

7. BENEFITS TO EVERYONE INVOLVED — BEFORE & AFTER IGNITE

IGNITE is designed so that no stakeholder is asked to give more than they get back. This section sets out, plainly, what changes for each of them.

7.1 The Balanced Student-Life Formula

IGNITE is designed to complement academics by integrating internships, practical projects, industry sessions and skill development around the academic calendar. Certificates and stipends may be available depending on individual company opportunities and are not guaranteed by IGNITE.

Academics + Practical Experience + Knowledge + Certificates + Stipend (where possible)
= A Balanced Student Life

7.2 Before IGNITE, With IGNITE

Before	With IGNITE
Individual outreach	Structured branch-to-company pathway
Limited opportunity visibility	Centralised opportunity portal
Skill gaps discovered late	Early skill-gap mapping
Unstructured escalation	Branch → IGNITE → Placement escalation

The intent behind every part of this model is the same: make the route from classroom to real-world experience quicker, more accurate, and more effortless than it is today — for every branch, not just one.

7.3 Benefits by Stakeholder

Stakeholder	Primary Benefit
Students	Internships, projects, skills and industry exposure
Faculty	Current industry feedback and verified student data
Placement Department	Better-prepared students and structured outreach support
University	Stronger industry ties and cross-branch engagement
Industry	Access to motivated, multi-branch student talent

8. POSITIONING WITH THE PLACEMENT DEPARTMENT

IGNITE is designed to complement — not replace — the Placement Department. It prepares students earlier, so they arrive at placement season more skilled, more experienced, and more confident.

	Placement Department	IGNITE
Focus	Final-year recruitment drives	1st- to 3rd-year skill-building and internship preparation
Audience	Students ready for placement	Students from every year and every branch
Method	Company tie-ups for full-time roles	Internship pipeline, skill workshops, structured industry exposure

	Placement Department	IGNITE
Outcome	Job placements	Internship-ready, skilled, placement-prepared students
Relationship	Institutional authority	Student-led, faculty-guided, and placement-supported

8.1 The Proposed Working Relationship

IGNITE proposes a straightforward, ongoing working relationship with the Placement Department, built around Section 3's escalation model:

	Detail
IGNITE Offers	A steady stream of branch-vetted company leads that the Placement Department does not currently have the bandwidth to originate on its own; a structured, student-led outreach channel that runs every semester
Placement Dept. Provides	Institutional weight for the outreach that individual branches cannot close on their own, and a formal working relationship that recognises IGNITE as a student-led industry-liaison arm

9. GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE & CORE PROGRAMS

9.1 Structure

Role	Count	Responsibilities
IGNITE President / Student Initiator	1	Vision, Main Committee coordination, institutional representation
Faculty Mentor(s)	1–2 per branch, ideally	Guidance, institutional support, sign-off on branch-level asks
Placement Dept. Liaison	1	Coordinates escalated outreach, pipeline management
Branch Representatives	2 per branch	Run their branch's Internal Branch Committee; first point of contact for their branch
Internal Branch Committee	Branch Reps + branch faculty	Diagnose branch-specific challenges; build the branch's target company list
Core Team	Small, hand-picked	Cross-branch coordination, workshops, portal content, communications

9.2 Core Programs

Program	Frequency
Internship Orientation	Start of semester
SkillBoost Workshops	Monthly

Program	Frequency
Industry Engagement	Bi-monthly / ongoing
Career Preparation — CV, interviews, alumni	Twice/semester
Company Visits & Cross-Branch Sessions	Quarterly / monthly

10. OUR CORE TEAM

Current Core Team: The founding team currently consists of four members and will expand through branch representatives as IGNITE enters its institutional phase.

Name	Role
Sai Gandhi V	Student Initiator & Team Lead
Pawan V	Core Team Member
Shaik Umme Sara	Core Team Member
Aishwarya	Core Team Member
T. Ramnarayan Srivatsankith	Core Team Member
Bhuvaneshwari	Core Team Member
Zaid Ahmed	Core Team Member
Rashmitha	Core Team Member
Vishal S Temkar	Core Team Member
Abhishaya	Core Team Member

11. OPERATIONAL MODEL & SUSTAINABILITY

IGNITE is built to run, grow, and sustain itself using people, structured process, and data — not institutional budgets.

Area	Approach
Infrastructure	Existing labs/seminar rooms
Industry Sessions	Voluntary/sponsored participation
Digital Portal	In-house development
Operations	Student-driven with faculty guidance

Area	Approach
Continuity	Annual transfer of documented processes, contacts and systems

12. PROPOSED LAUNCH ROADMAP

Phase	Timeline	Key Milestones
Phase 0 — Already Done	2025 – mid-2026	Four research studies completed; Letter of Appreciation received; Faculty Mentor secured (Dr.M C MURUGESH); proposal drafted; digital portal development begun
Phase 1 — Foundation	Month 1–2 post-approval	Formal club/committee registration; Branch Representatives appointed across all branches; Internal Branch Committees formed
Phase 2 — Launch	Month 2–4	First Internship Orientation session; first SkillBoost workshops; first companies onboarded through the branch-level workflow (Section 3)
Phase 3 — Portal Pilot	Month 4–8	Digital portal piloted with the first onboarded companies and volunteering students; refined directly from their feedback
Phase 4 — Scale	Month 8 onward	Portal opened to all onboarded companies and students across every branch; formal Placement Dept. integration; research publication

13. WHAT WE ARE REQUESTING

IGNITE has done the groundwork independently. What it asks for now is deliberately modest — support, guidance, and formal recognition, not funding or infrastructure.

13.1 For IGNITE

- Institutional recognition — formal registration of IGNITE as a **committee** of the university, open to every engineering branch equally.
- Continued support and guidance — from the Faculty Mentor, department faculty, and university officials, as the branch/committee structure (Section 3) and the digital portal (Section 4) take shape.
- Basic operating access — a regular meeting-room or lab slot for workshops, and permission to use official notice boards and student communication channels across branches.

13.2 For the Student Initiator

Separately from IGNITE's own registration, one specific personal request is made on behalf of the Student Initiator:

A Dean-Signed Letter of Recognition

A formal letter from the Dean's office recognising Sai Gandhi V's independent research and institution-building work — under a non-technical title such as Student Researcher or Academic Researcher. This is not a technical certification; it is a record of independent academic contribution, intended to support future academic and career opportunities beyond MSRUAS.

The Ask Is Minimal. The Return Is Significant.

IGNITE asks for institutional recognition, continued guidance, and a small amount of communication access. In return, the university gets a self-sustaining, cross-branch industry pipeline, a research-backed operating model, and a growing body of independent student research — at zero cost to the institution.

14. CLOSING STATEMENT

"Every student at MSRUAS deserves to graduate with not just a degree,
but a career already in motion."
The data is clear. The need is real. The working model is ready.

We look forward to your guidance, suggestions, and support in making IGNITE a lasting institution at M.S. Ramaiah University of Applied Sciences.

Respectfully submitted,

Sai Gandhi V and Core Team

Student Initiator, IGNITE
4th Year B.Tech, Mechanical Engineering
MSRUAS, Bengaluru | 2026

Faculty Mentor,

Dr. M C MURUGESH

Faculty Mentor, IGNITE
Department of Mechanical Engineering
MSRUAS, Bengaluru | 2026

Endorsed by,

Dr. Suresh R

Head of Department, Mechanical Engineering
MSRUAS, Bengaluru | 2026

Reviewed by,

Dr. B.S. Dayananda

Associate Dean — Academics
MSRUAS, Bengaluru | 2026